

CoolerMaster Cosmos Cosmopolitan!

CoolerMaster (CM) has always catered to enthusiasts with their Stacker series of cabinets, which represent the upper echelon of the world of desktop cases. The Cosmos (codename RC1000) deviates from the hardcore (and pricey) Stackers, with something that offers designer looks.

Brushed steel is rare but always a hit, and the Cosmos sports panel quality and a finish second to none—even better than CMs own RC830 series. It has two aluminium bars on the top and bottom. The front door is equally attractive—tinted fibre and you can change its orientation (left or right). We also noticed the two rubber covered holes in the back of the cabinet—perfect for the tubes of a liquid cooling kit.

There's a fan on the bottom of the case handling

air intake, while the two fans on the top and one rear fan are exhausts. CM states this creates some negative pressure—which explains why they have a VGA duct without a fan—it's bang in the middle of this negative pressure region, and should divert air onto hot running graphics cards. Our 8800GTX did keep its cool even during long gaming sessions. Dust filters have been provided at appropriate areas—these are easy to remove and clean. The power supply mounts at the bottom—similar to Antec's P180.

Removing the side panels is as easy as flicking a switch.

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

There's a lot of space to work with inside, and the first difference is the six hard drive trays complete with handles—hard drives will now sit sideways (vertically), which restricts airflow—particularly since they're 3 drive rails in a row.

Everything from the side panels and power supply housing, to the HDD trays and the fan mounts have silent, rubber treatment to keep the dBs down.

The Cosmos is undeniably attractive. If you want class and have money to burn, it makes a good buy. It also makes sense as housing for an overclocked, water cooled setup. As far as air cooling goes, the better-ventilated Stacker RC830 will outperform (though it costs more). The only downside we can come up with is the choice of metal—steel—which makes the Cosmos a hefty proposition at 16.9 Kg. We're told there's an aluminium (and costlier) version coming soon.



Specifications

Dimensions—W x H x D—266 x 598 x 628 mm, weight—16.9 kgs, Form factor—Mid Tower, 3.5 inch bays—6, No of fans—2 x 120 mm

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Web site: www.coolermaster.com
Price: Rs 14,500

Intel QX9650 Speed buster

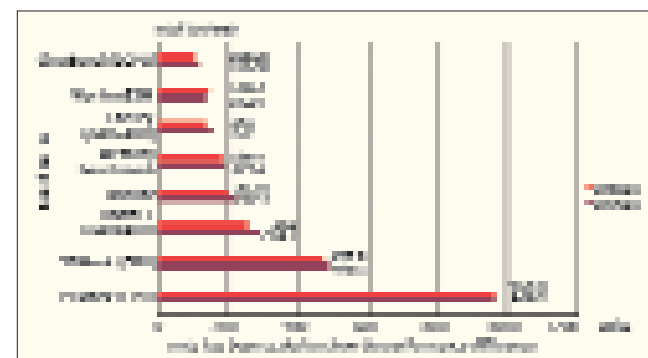
It hasn't been a month since our processor shootout, and Intel has fired yet another salvo—the QX9650—a top rung, quad core processor based on the 45 nm manufacturing process, which is the key differentiator between the QX6850 and the QX9650—the former is built on the 65 nm process.

The QX9650 runs at 3 GHz, with 1333 MHz FSB and is well supplemented with a cache of 6 MB per die—12 MB total, 2 MB more than the QX6850 per core.

Intel has also introduced 47 new instruction sets in the form of SSE4—this should improve performance in

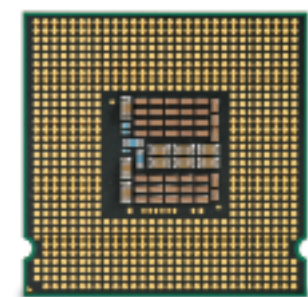
multimedia applications. In Sciencemark, the QX9650 shows a nearly 10

per cent performance improvement over the older QX6850 in all the subtests, except in cryptography, which is affected by clock speed. In games such as Doom



RATINGS	
Feature	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

3, Far Cry and Company of Heroes, we see a definite increase in performance by 10 to 15 per cent. 3D Mark and PC Mark also show perceivable performance



differences. We've got to say there is definite performance improvement across the board.

Price hasn't been disclosed yet, but expect it to be somewhere around Rs 50,000 when it becomes available.

Specifications

Quad core, 3 GHz, 1333 MHz FSB, 12 MB L2 cache

Contact: Intel India Pvt Ltd
Web site: www.intel.com
Price: Rs 52,000 (approx)

Kingston DataTraveler 100 4GB A no-frills pen drive

A USB pen drive is meant to carry your data. Well, that's what the Kingston DataTraveler 100 4GB is all about (also available 1, 2, and 8 GB). The drive is sleek and beautifully crafted in a black polymer casing. Unlike most other drives, this one has a retractable USB port that slides out using a thumb button at the side. The drive and the sliding mechanism exude ruggedness.

Simplicity is key here. The drive does not support Vista's ReadyBoost feature, but is compatible with different operating systems such as Windows Vista / XP / 2000, Mac OS and Linux. The drive does not sport U3 capability, so forget about carrying your

desktop with you. A disappointment for those who are paranoid about security is that it does not come with any encryption, security or backup software. The lack of (resource-taxing) on-the-fly encryption does not result in a speedier performance—instead, the drive seems lethargic and takes three minutes to transfer a 700 MB file to it, while copying it back takes just 53.1 seconds though. It is plain and simple that the Flash memory used in this drive is not very fast, but keep in mind that this is a value product and this lack of performance was anticipated. The amount of time taken to transfer the data is within acceptable



you are concerned with data security and need higher speeds, however, we suggest that you go for its mightier sibling, the DataTraveler Secure 8 GB, which we tested a few months ago.

limits and therefore, for its price, the Kingston DataTraveler 100 4GB is good value. It's backed by a solid 5 year warranty from Kingston and that makes it a very attractive option for portable data storage and transfer. If

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Build Quality	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Specifications

Capacity: 4 GB; Interface: USB 2.0; Lanyard; Dimensions: 2.04 (W) x 0.9 (D) x 6.69 (H) mm; Weight: 11.3 gm

Contact: Kingston Technology
Phone: 1800-425-4515 (Toll Free)
E-mail: techsupport_india@kingston.com
Web site: www.kingston.com/india
Price: Rs 2,272

Xerox Phaser 6110 MFP The affordable colour laser MFD

We were drawn to the Xerox Phaser 6110 by the rather non-office looks and its price tag, which is quite attractive. It's considerably compact when compared to any laser MFD, but its 20.5 kg weight is somewhat high, we think. The easy front loading toners go straight inside the body vertically rather than horizontally, so there is little chance of your hands getting dirty.

The input tray capacity is 150 sheets—comfortable for any SoHo, and if that is not enough, an optional tray can support an additional 250 sheets. The ADF can hold 50 sheets and makes life easier while copying multiple documents using the flatbed-cum-sheetfed scanner. The scanner supports up to legal size paper. The control panel is very easy to use and the 16-character, 2-line display gives a lot of information. At the

front is a USB port that lets you plug in a USB stick and print its contents. You can even connect a PictBridge camera to this port using its data cable to print photos without a PC.

Print quality is good and crisp in both black-and-white and colour prints. It was pretty fast, too, taking just 11 seconds for black and 14.9 for the colour print. The scanner performed flawlessly—displaying excellent colour recognition and capturing fine details well. Scanning a 600 dpi, A4 photo took just 45.3 seconds. It was a bit slow at copying—14.8 seconds for black and 35.5 for colour—but the copies were so good that it was hard to distinguish between the original and the copy.

It features USB as well as network interface. The fax supports delayed fax and has 4 MB of memory for

storing received faxes in standby mode. Bundled along is the Maintenance Utility that lets you perform routine maintenance tasks, and a utility to set up the device over a network. The price is a surprisingly affordable Rs.39,900, and that makes the Xerox Phaser 6110MFP a highly recommended product.

Specifications

Printer: Resolution: 2,400 x 600 dpi (effective), Input tray: 150 sheets, Output tray: 100 sheets, Buffer memory: 128 MB; Scanner: Type: Flatbed and Sheetfed, Resolution: 600 x 1,200 dpi (Optical), Media size: Legal, ADF: 50 sheets;

RATINGS	
Features	★★★★★
Performance	★★★★★
Ease of Use	★★★★★
Value for Money	★★★★★
Overall	★★★★★

Fax: Speed: 33.6 Kbps, Memory: 4 MB, Speed dialing: up to 240 numbers; General Specifications: Dimensions: 46.6(W) x 42.9(D) x 48.6(H) mm, Weight: 20.5 Kg Power Consumption: Max: 350W, Standby: 30W Duty cycle: Printer: 24,000 prints per month, Black toner: 2,000 pages, Colour toner: 1,000 pages

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Web site: www.xerox.com
Price: Rs 39,900